A PRACTICAL CONTENT-FORMAT GUIDE

Bring your stories. Find their *shape.*

Eight flexible formats to turn what you know, notice and experience into content that feels like you.

> Start with a person you want to help and one thing worth saying. Then choose the format that makes that idea easiest to understand.

Use these for spoken videos, voiceovers, carousels or written posts. You do not need to use every format, share your private life or manufacture a dramatic transformation.

Your simplest starting point

Write down one question you answered, one decision you made and one thing you learned this week. Choose one. Give it a shape using the pages that follow.

FORMAT 01 / 08

The moment that changed your mind

Help people understand your perspective.

Bring this
A small incident, conversation or turning point.

Give it a shape

1. Set the scene: what did you believe or expect?
2. Describe the moment that challenged it.
3. Explain what you do or think differently now.

One possible opening

What changed my mind about [topic] was [specific moment].

Make it yours

What would you interpret differently if it happened again?

Keep in mind
Open on the relevant moment; avoid a long life history.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

FORMAT 02 / 08

One useful lesson

Share expertise without delivering an entire course.

Bring this
A question you understand well or a mistake you can explain.

Give it a shape

1. Name one specific difficulty.
2. Explain one practical action and why it helps.
3. Clarify when it applies and any important limits.

One possible opening

Before trying [task], check [one relevant detail].

Make it yours

What is one thing someone could try after watching?

Keep in mind
Show the action if it is easier to see than explain.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

FORMAT 03 / 08

Your point of view

Make your reasoning recognisable.

Bring this
An opinion you can support with experience or evidence.

Give it a shape

1. State the view plainly.
2. Give the observation or reasoning behind it.
3. Acknowledge an exception or trade-off.

One possible opening

I care more about [priority] than [common priority] in [context].

Make it yours

Where does your view stop being useful?

Keep in mind
Disagree with an idea without attacking a person.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

FORMAT 04 / 08

Behind the decision

Show the thought behind your work.

Bring this
A choice you made during a project or routine.

Give it a shape

1. Show the task or work in progress.
2. Explain one choice you made.
3. Describe the trade-off or intended benefit.

One possible opening

I changed [detail] in this [output] because [reason].

Make it yours

What would an outsider miss about this decision?

Keep in mind
Use your own screen, notes or footage; clear client permissions first.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

FORMAT 05 / 08

Show one small process

Make your expertise tangible.

Bring this
A manageable task someone can watch or follow.

Give it a shape

1. Show the starting state.
2. Demonstrate the essential steps.
3. Show the output and explain what to check.

One possible opening

Here's how I approach one small part of [task].

Make it yours

What does a beginner need to notice at each step?

Keep in mind
Use captions that clarify the action, rather than covering the frame.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

FORMAT 06 / 08

Answer a real question

Respond to something your audience needs.

Bring this
A genuine question from a conversation, enquiry or comment.

Give it a shape

1. State the question without exposing private details.
2. Give the direct answer.
3. Explain the condition or next step that matters.

One possible opening

How do you know when [task] is ready?

Make it yours

What assumption behind the question needs explaining?

Keep in mind
If you invent a useful hypothetical question, label it as a question you would ask—not a real audience message.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

FORMAT 07 / 08

An honest progress update

Build familiarity while you learn or develop something.

Bring this
A change you can describe accurately.

Give it a shape

1. Say what you tried and why.
2. Share what you observed.
3. Say what you'll keep, change or investigate next.

One possible opening

I tried [change]. Here's what I noticed so far.

Make it yours

What is still uncertain?

Keep in mind
Distinguish observations from causes; do not imply a change proved a result.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

FORMAT 08 / 08

An invitation to work together

Help interested people understand your service.

Bring this
A real offer with a clear scope.

Give it a shape

1. Describe the problem you help with.
2. Explain what you do and what the client contributes.
3. Give one next step and explain what follows.

One possible opening

Here's what you bring to [collaboration], and what I help with.

Make it yours

What would someone need to know before enquiring?

Keep in mind
Be specific about deliverables; avoid outcomes you cannot guarantee.

This is a flexible structure, not a required formula or guarantee of performance.

IDEA ≠ FORMAT ≠ HOOK

One story.
Several *choices.*

The idea is what you want to say. **The format** is the shape you give it. **The hook** is how you open it. Choose the idea before polishing the first line.

A professional
Idea: unclear handovers create confusion.
Format: behind a decision.
Opening: “I changed one part of our handover notes. It wasn’t the length.”
Body: show an anonymised or hypothetical owner-and-next-step field; explain why you use it.

A business owner
Idea: help customers choose between two offers.
Format: one useful lesson.
Opening: “These two options suit different needs. Start with how you’ll use them.”
Body: explain a real difference and its trade-off, without claiming one fits everyone.

A new creator
Idea: feeling awkward before a first post.
Format: an honest progress update.
Opening: “I recorded this twice. The third time, I stopped trying to sound like someone else.”
Body: only use this if true; share what you noticed and what you’ll try next.

A SMALL CONTENT SESSION

Start with something you already *have.*

1. **Collect:** a real question, decision, observation or lesson from your week. No dramatic event required.
2. **Choose:** one person who might find it useful and one takeaway.
3. **Shape:** pick a format from this guide. Talking to camera, voiceover, a screen recording or written slides can all carry it.
4. **Open:** choose a hook that matches the actual body. Remove any claim you cannot support.
5. **Finish:** give a takeaway or relevant invitation. You don't need to sell in every post.

Learn from the response
Compare several posts with similar topics and contexts. Where available, examine early viewer retention, completion, saves and meaningful replies. For business content, track relevant enquiries too. Different audiences, distribution and editing can affect results.

Keep the idea or opening that helps your intended audience understand you. A single high-view post does not prove that a sentence caused the result.

YOUR NEXT POST

A small plan.
A real *starting point.*

1. **Who is this for?** Name a person or situation, rather than everyone.
2. **What is the one idea?** Write it in a sentence.
3. **What can I actually show or explain?** Choose real material.
4. **Which format fits?** Pick from the eight; change it if needed.
5. **What should they take away?** A useful thought, practical action or clearer understanding.

Before you share

Check accuracy, permissions, readable text and clear sound. Remove details that distract from your main idea. You can be honest without revealing anything you want to keep private.

After posting, consider useful replies, saves and relevant enquiries alongside views. Use what you learn to choose the next idea. Avoid treating one post as proof that an approach always works.

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Want hands-on support? Tell me what you're building · @ray.chuaa